

Chapter 125 - Truth

Black Scales' terrifying aspect lay in close combat. Her ancient silver dagger seemed to stick to you once touched, always appearing before your eyes, and combined with her snake-like agile and resilient form, her techniques were airtight.

Ning Fuyi's Emei thorns weren't suited for face-to-face combat, so she was initially at a disadvantage. Just as she dodged the cold flash of the blade, three silver needles nearly pierced her forehead. Ning Fuyi broke out in a cold sweat, her body suddenly folding as she watched the silver needles pierce the wall, causing half the wall to melt like ice.

"She actually uses poison." Ning Fuyi raised her eyebrows, then rotated her left hand. Lightning crackled in her palm, forming a circular ring that pressed Black Scales to the ground. She then leaped into mid-air, creating distance between them.

Thunder gradually became clearer. Ning Fuyi brought her fingers together with both hands, forming seals in rhythm with the thunder. Then the sky suddenly brightened, and pink lightning bolts struck down toward Black Scales like pillars.

Black Scales raised her blade to shatter the ring, then turned and maneuvered her body, hiding among the ruins where she couldn't be found. Then a weak wind brushed past her face, and Ning Fuyi quickly summoned thunder horizontally in front of her, barely avoiding Black Scales' blade that seemed to emerge from void.

She was truly too fast. Ning Fuyi marveled - no wonder Penglai went to great lengths to keep this person. She was like an assassin with unpredictable movements; once entangled with her, it would be endless trouble.

The others around were also fighting more intensely. Countless snakes emerged everywhere, and the dead bodies almost wove into a snake carpet, covering the ground completely. The qilin's roar had faded into the distance as it wrestled with some giant snake's body, finally breathing fire to burn it to ashes.

Strangely, those giant snakes didn't pile up in the distance after death, but each transformed into human bodies, glaring with wide eyes at the dark dome above.

Ning Fuyi looked at those people and immediately felt chilled to the bone, but the troublesome dagger had already stabbed toward her nose tip again. She could only quickly withdraw her attention and focus entirely on dealing with Black Scales.

Black Scales had already noticed Tang Wenshu and Chu Qingqiu who were extinguishing the fire. She flew to intercept them, but Ning Fuyi summoned heavenly thunder to split open a chasm, forcibly blocking her path.

"Do you know what that fire is! You help Penglai use human flesh and blood to refine this world-destroying thing - doesn't your conscience feel uneasy?" Ning Fuyi shouted sternly, then raised her hand to throw out her Emei thorns.

The Emei thorns spun in mid-air, lightning gathering into a sphere, striking toward Black Scales with lightning speed. Black Scales hurriedly defended, but couldn't withstand Ning Fuyi's full-force attack. Her body suddenly retreated, spitting out blood flowers in mid-air.

The blood scattered to the ground and quickly disappeared into the soil.

She seemed to be enraged, suddenly charging at Ning Fuyi regardless of everything, passing like light and shadow, so fast it was terrifying. Waves of thunder couldn't strike her.

Ning Fuyi was raising her hand to defend when she split into four simultaneously as she approached, attacking from all sides. Ning Fuyi quickly blocked three sides, but was caught off guard from behind. Immediately her vision blurred and her body flew out.

She retrieved her Emei thorns in mid-air to steady herself, but still crashed through many bricks and tiles before half-kneeling in the dust.

Her chest was wet. She raised her hand to touch it - blood had somehow flowed from her mouth, dripping all over her body.

Baili Shiqi, who witnessed this, let out a cry of alarm. At the same time, icy air swept around, and Ning Fuyi watched the ground freeze inch by inch.

Then the White Bone, transformed into a white jade staff, descended from the sky. Gang winds carrying cold air swept across the fortress, sweeping away countless black snakes while transforming into countless wind blades that all stabbed toward Black Scales.

Even with Black Scales' extremely fast movement technique, she was hit by several blades, staggering to support her body. Her curled black hair covered half her face as she looked numbly toward the newcomer.

Chu Qingqiu stood in mid-air at some point, her face like frost and snow, cold and silent. Her anger transformed into divine pressure, overwhelming the area.

"Divine Venerable?" Hua Feihua, who was resisting the snake tide together with Liu Wenzhu, looked up in shock. But he quickly dared not be distracted, as more snakes rushed toward them desperately. From afar, they stretched for miles with terrifying momentum, turning solid stones to powder wherever they passed, seeming to completely engulf this place.

"Not good, they want to devour this place!" Liu Wenzhu said despairingly. Her body was already bitten with several bloody holes by snakes, and she stumbled and fell, fortunately supported by Hua Feihua.

"Chu Qingqiu, go help Wenzhu!" After the severe chest pain eased somewhat, Ning Fuyi shouted loudly at her.

Across the snake mountains, blood seas, and billowing dust, she raised her hand in a gesture and smiled brilliantly at Chu Qingqiu: "Don't worry."

Chu Qingqiu gripped the White Bone that was burning with blazing white light, stared at her for half a moment, then turned and appeared in front of Liu Wenzhu. The White Bone immediately grew several times larger, spinning to sweep away the snake tide.

Ning Fuyi painfully withdrew her smile. She wiped the blood from the corner of her mouth with her sleeve, half-crawling while watching Black Scales transform into an arrow with her peripheral vision.

Black Scales grew closer, using the same technique to create duplicates. However, just as the dagger was about to pierce the woman's heart, it was suddenly blocked by a barrier. Dazzling pink light surrounded her body, steady as a rock. Black Scales looked up in surprise.

A complex magical formation rose from beneath the woman's feet, shaped like a swimming dragon, making her robes flutter like wings. Those phoenix eyes were unfathomably deep, faintly reflecting brilliant rays of light.

As she uttered a low "Break," brilliant lightning suddenly burst from her chest. The extremely powerful heavenly thunder seemed capable of shattering heaven and earth. Black Scales couldn't dodge in time and was struck squarely in the heart, her body scraping across the ground with sparks, rolling and tumbling.

Her forehead hit a brick, leaving a patch of bright red.

Ning Fuyi's chest felt like it was tearing apart. She slowly stood up, her Emei thorns whistling out again, piercing harshly into Black Scales' heart. The woman gritted her teeth and looked up, her beautiful eyes tightly closed, swallowing the non-existent cry of pain.

A sound of something falling came from beside her. Ning Fuyi blocked the dust to look and saw the frail-looking Jiang Li collapsed on the ground, tears brimming in her eyes amid disheveled hair.

"Medical Immortal Jiang..." Ning Fuyi tried to help Jiang Li, but helplessly she was also severely injured and could only take two steps before bending over to gasp.

Behind her, Jiuying's massive body chased a giant snake with thundering steps, trampling the rubble even smaller.

Black Scales' slender legs curled up, her pale five fingers covering the wound on her chest. She endured the piercing pain and suddenly pulled out the Emei thorns forcefully, throwing them down.

She suddenly began chanting obscure and sinister incantations. The broken totems around seemed to come alive instantly, the snakes atop the human figures writhing seductively, terrifyingly eerie.

Ning Fuyi's movements paused for a moment, then her ears twitched slightly. The sound of belly-scraping against ground gradually became deafening, accompanied by countless gasping sounds like people breathing, like gales rushing over mountains, surging forth violently.

"My heavens." Liu Wenzhu's hands holding the thousand-pound hammer trembled, involuntarily retreating.

In the distance appeared ring-shaped high mountains that seemed to rise from the ground, with deep chasms cracking the earth.

When the mountains drew near, one could see they weren't mountains at all, but countless snakes entangled together, rushing toward them with world-devouring momentum.

"You're insane!" Jiang Li called out weakly, but her voice was drowned in the wind, leaving only silent despair.

"It's a snake swarm." Ning Fuyi shouted loudly. "Chu Qingqiu!"

A faint scent of gardenia flowers drifted by as Chu Qingqiu gracefully landed in front of her, coldly looking toward those snake mountains. She extended the White Bone to block in front of Ning Fuyi, but was pulled behind Ning Fuyi instead.

The others also ran over quickly, standing back to back with tense nerves.

With so many snakes, if they surged to the surface, it would definitely be a catastrophe!

"Medical Immortal Jiang, come quickly!" Liu Wenzhu grabbed the dejected Jiang Li from the ground, trying to protect her among them, but Jiang Li kept shaking her head, desperately pushing her hands away.

"Don't be afraid, I have a way, I have a way..." she murmured in a low voice, raising her hand to wipe away tears, then suddenly used immortal power to create a sharp knife, stabbing it harshly into her heart.

"Jiang Li!" Ning Fuyi hurried to stop her, but couldn't overcome her determined movements. She stabbed in once, then pulled it out violently, her chest immediately becoming bright red.

Everyone was somewhat stunned, watching as she squeezed threads of immortal power from her fingertips, condensing her heart's blood into a red blood pearl floating before her eyes.

The incantations in Black Scales' mouth became confused, and the snake mountains slowed considerably.

"Little Black Snake, I beg you, please stop!" Her voice was hoarse, tears streaming down, "Penglai has plenty of extremely evil people. They use the people of Xuanyuan Kingdom to refine Infinite Ghost Fire¹! They aren't uncivilized snakes - they're all citizens of Xuanyuan Kingdom!"

"Look at those giant snakes - after death they all transform into human bodies. They're clanspeople of the Black Snake tribe!"

Black Scales stared fixedly at the blood pearl, completely breaking off the incantations in her mouth, saying in a low voice: "They have no consciousness, no knowledge or feeling, and have always obeyed Penglai's commands."

"I was born loyal to Penglai, loyal to the Emperor. You're helping this demon disrupt Penglai's great affairs - stop spouting nonsense!" Black Scales' fingertips trembled, her voice hollow.

"They have no consciousness or awareness not because they're snakes, but because their snake tendons were extracted and snake hearts carved out to refine fire. That's why they reverted to their original forms, becoming walking corpses for others to control!" Jiang Li shook her head sorrowfully.

"What are you saying..."

"You're not from Penglai. You're a snake, the last main bloodline of the Black Snake tribe! You went down the mountain to study medical arts to treat the stubborn ailments of the Black Snake tribe, but Penglai erased your memory and trained you as a slave. They used you to open Xuanyuan Kingdom's barriers, slaughtered the remaining Black Snake clanspeople, and used the Xuanyuan Kingdom buried in sand to refine Infinite Ghost Fire!"

"I originally didn't want to awaken all your memories. I didn't dare let you face the truth. As long as the ghost fire could be extinguished, as long as you could return to my side, I could selfishly pretend nothing had happened. But now you actually want to kill everyone!"

The light in Black Scales' eyes swirled chaotically. She helplessly groped for the ancient silver dagger that had fallen to the ground: "I, I don't believe it."

"You don't believe it?" Jiang Li suddenly laughed. Her body was like duckweed, desolate and broken, yet her voice was shocking: "Fine, I'll make you believe!"

She placed her swollen fingertip on her forehead, then orange-yellow starlight flew out like catkins. The dark clouds overhead were colored by the rosy light, magnificently black and red.

Baili Shiqi had already started crying. Ning Fuyi gripped Chu Qingqiu's hand tightly, and everyone felt deeply powerless, only able to watch helplessly.

"She's using her heart's blood to restore erased memories?" Hua Feihua said in amazement.

Liu Wenzhu spoke gently: "She's the most outstanding Medical Immortal among all the Jiang family members throughout history."

At the same time, the rosy light became brilliantly blinding for an instant. Black Scales' pupils were suddenly occupied by light, causing her to scream shrilly in pain. Jiang Li's heart's blood scattered into blood mist, surging into her forehead together.

The screaming lasted long, finally turning into wailing - indescribably sorrowful and angry. The snake mountain suddenly sank into the earth.

Black Scales' previously numb expression changed. Hot tears poured from her eyes, seeming to have blood mixed with tears falling. She screamed desperately until she finally had no voice left, yet still couldn't suppress it.

Overwhelming hatred filled the entire world, making all who heard it red-eyed.

After an unknown time, Black Scales finally fell to her knees, her fingers curling into the sand, hatred with nowhere to vent, painful to the point of helplessness.

"Leave quickly." A hoarse voice suddenly rang out. Black Scales knelt on the ground, supporting her body with both hands, unable to hide her pain. "The miasma is coming."

At the same time, black mist rose everywhere. Rocks and sand were quickly swallowed by the miasma. This miasma was obviously different from before - one could almost hear the swallowing sounds of ghostly regions.

The moment she saw the miasma, Chu Qingqiu's White Bone had already shot into the air. White light dispersed the thick clouds, fiercely shattering the sky-high stone walls overhead, revealing swirling sand outside the earth's crust.

Hua Feihua dragged the still-unconscious Hua Feiwu from the collapsed latrine and flew out underground against the sandstorm. The others followed suit, while Ning Fuyi called back the red-eyed Jiuying, signaling her to leave quickly.

The qilin roared past with firelight, like fireworks ascending to heaven, exploding star-shaped stone walls. At this time the miasma had already swept over. Ning Fuyi grabbed the already-unconscious Jiang Li and took flight together with Chu Qingqiu.

Black Scales' figure was already submerged in the miasma, but although Ning Fuyi's emotions fluctuated accordingly, she wasn't worried about her safety.

"Wait, it seems we're missing someone." Ning Fuyi suddenly stopped in mid-air, while below had already been filled with miasma, dark as hell.

"Tang Wenshu!" Chu Qingqiu frowned. "He didn't get out."

As soon as Chu Qingqiu spoke, she was about to dive back into the black mist, but Ning Fuyi stopped her and handed Jiang Li to her instead.

"I'll go." Ning Fuyi said, then her lips stained with blood lightly brushed past her cheek like a dragonfly touching water. "Divine Venerable, wait for me above."

Footnotes:

1. **Infinite Ghost Fire (无极鬼火)** - A legendary primordial fire that can burn anything and never be extinguished, as established in previous chapters.